

KEEP THIS ONE; IT'S BUILT TO LIVE INSIDE YOUR GRADEBOOK

AI & Academic Integrity: Setting Clear Expectations with Students

THE STANCE

Clarity beats policing. Name the lane on every assignment.
And no accusation ever rests on a detector score alone.

The three lanes

Lane	What it means	The one-line label
1 · AI-free	The point is your own thinking, from scratch.	"AI-free. This one is all you; I need to see your own thinking to teach you well."
2 · AI-assisted	Brainstorm, feedback, and polish allowed; the thinking stays yours; use is disclosed.	"AI-assisted. Brainstorming and feedback are fine; write the final yourself and note what you used."
3 · AI-included	Using AI well is part of the task; judgment is what's graded.	"AI-included. Use the tool; show your prompts; your judgment is what's being graded."

Parts can differ: "research lane 3, final draft lane 1" is a perfectly good answer. Name a lane per part and print it on the assignment.

The disclosure norm (lane 2's engine)

Two lines at the end of the work: **what tool I used** and **what it did for me**. "I used a chatbot to brainstorm three opening ideas and picked one." Disclosure is citation pointed at AI: it turns AI use from a secret into a skill.

The soft-landing rule: if a student disclosed it, the conversation is coaching, not consequences. Punish disclosure once and you've taught the whole class to hide.

The AI-expectation box (template)

Lane: [1 · AI-free / 2 · AI-assisted / 3 · AI-included], because [one honest sentence about what this assignment teaches].

Okay: [what's allowed, in student words]

Not okay: [what's not, in student words]

If you used AI: add two lines at the end: what tool, and what it did for you.

If something seems off: I'll ask you to walk me through your work. That's a conversation, not an accusation.

Four design moves (one is usually enough)

- **Make thinking visible:** collect the outline, the draft, the version history; grade the journey.
- **Anchor it locally:** tie the task to what happened in your room; a chatbot was never in your class.
- **Move some thinking live:** a two-minute "defend your choice," an in-class quick-write; normal, not gotcha.
- **Assess the process:** where AI is allowed, grade the prompts, the disclosure, and a short accept/reject reflection.

The conversation, scripted

Move	Say
Open with curiosity	"Walk me through how you made this. What did you start with? What was the hardest part?"
Get specific	"Tell me more about this paragraph. What does this word mean here?"
Gather process evidence	Can they explain their choices? Is there a draft? Does in-class writing match?
Land it	First offense under a new expectation: teach the lane, reset, move on. Pattern: follow your school's process, with the process evidence in hand.

The never list: never open with "did you use AI?" · never accuse on a detector score alone (OpenAI shut down its own detector for low accuracy; commercial detectors flagged over half of real essays by non-native English speakers as AI) · never make it public · never forget most students were never told the rule.

Why clarity is the whole game

- **Use is normal:** 54% of teens use AI for schoolwork (Pew, 2026); guidance lags adoption (RAND, 2025).
- **The rate didn't spike:** self-reported cheating held at 60–70% before and after ChatGPT (Lee, Pope et al., 2024). The problem is older than the bot.

- **Why kids cheat:** pressure, disengagement, feeling disrespected; rarely tool access (Stanford GSE).
- **What integrity protects:** honesty, trust, fairness, respect, responsibility, courage (ICAI).

My two sentences for the hard moment (draft them here)

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